

Let's Beat Breast Cancer

*Awareness today
Health tomorrow.*



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Breast Cancer: The most common cancer among women

The incidence of breast cancer is increasing at an alarming rate and in India 1 in 22 women have a risk of developing breast cancer in their lifetime. Though, we cannot prevent it, early detection is our best step towards cure. Only 10% of breast cancers are associated with family history or genetic mutations.

Know your risk:

There are non-modifiable risk factors that we cannot change like,

- ❖ Female gender
- ❖ Increasing age
- ❖ Family history of cancer
- ❖ Early age of menarche
- ❖ Menopause after 55

Modifiable risk factors

that increase risk include:

- ❖ First childbirth after 30 years of age
- ❖ Not breast feeding the child
- ❖ Not having children
- ❖ Obesity, especially post-menopausal weight gain
- ❖ Use of hormone replacement therapy after menopause

Early detection saves lives

- ❖ For women without genetic mutation or strong family history (average risk), guidelines recommend Xray mammogram once every two years for women aged 40-74 years.
- ❖ For high-risk individuals (genetic mutations or family history of cancer), reach out to your breast surgeon for more detailed information.

The common signs and symptoms of breast cancer include,

- ❖ Painless lump in the Breast or armpit
- ❖ Nipple discharge / retraction
- ❖ Changes in the skin over the breast like, puckering/ redness/ thickening
- ❖ Change in the shape or size of one breast
- ❖ Pain is often a sign of advanced stages of cancer

Diagnosis is done by using the triple test which includes Clinical examination, imaging (Mammogram +/- USG) and confirmation by biopsy.

Treatment of breast cancer entails a multimodality approach, with a combination of surgery, chemotherapy, radiation and hormonal therapy.

SURGERY

Breast conserving surgery is safe, especially for women with early breast cancer & along with oncoplasty allows for improved cosmetic outcomes. Surgery includes removal of the primary lump with negative margins and surgery for the lymph nodes under the arm pit (axilla).

CHOICE MATTERS

The primary of breast tumor removal can be done by lumpectomy (breast conserving) or mastectomy (removal of the breast). Breast conserving / preserving surgery is often the preferred choice for women with early breast cancer and along with use of radiation therapy is as safe as removal of the breast.

ADVANCED COMPASSIONATE CARE

Robotic breast surgery offers smaller scars, better cosmetic outcome and faster recovery in many women. Additionally breast reconstruction can be offered with silicone implants or body's own tissue, resulting in better body image and quality of life.

HEALING WHOLE, LIVING BETTER

Quality life is an important focus of treatment of breast cancer, to this effect, oncologists now personalise treatments for individual patients and efforts are being made to reduce side effects and help women recover better. A study evaluating the role of yoga as complementary therapy to standard breast cancer treatment has shown reduction of fatigue and improvement in of quality of life. Yoga is not used as treatment or prevention of cancer. It promotes good health and helps women on treatment for cancer, to have fewer side effects.

What to do when diagnosed with breast cancer?

- Do not panic or fear the unknown.
- Go prepared for your visit to the oncologist so you can ask questions and alleviate your anxiety.

*Awareness creates knowledge.. Knowledge gives us power...
it is our best defense against breast cancer.*

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